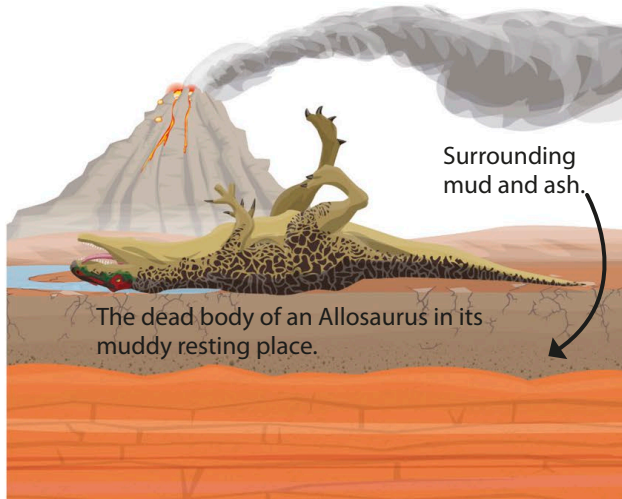


Fossilization

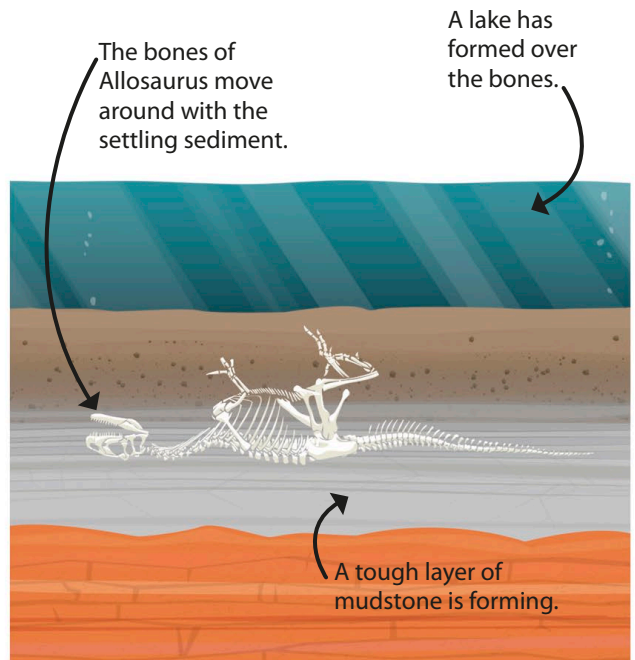
The process of fossilization turns dinosaur remains into stone. Some dead dinosaurs became buried under layers of mud over many millions of years. Chemical changes caused their bones to be replaced with stone. These fossils are rocky replicas of dinosaurs, preserving the past for all time. This gives paleontologists, who are scientists that study fossils, an incredible opportunity to see what they looked like.



147 MILLION YEARS AGO

Death

This Allosaurus died at the end of the Jurassic period from sickness, old age, or injury. Its body lies in soft mud by a shallow river, while a distant, erupting volcano pours lava and ash onto the land. If scavengers stay away, the fossilization process can begin.



100 MILLION YEARS AGO

Burial

The river carries sediments like mud, sand, and ash, which cover the dinosaur's body. The flesh and organs rot away, leaving only bones behind. Over millions of years, more layers of sediment are added, and heat and pressure build up, causing the layers to harden into solid rock called mudstone.